

Business

1. Lego just posted record first-half revenue — impressive for a toy company in a cost-conscious world. What made the result especially unusual?

- a. Sales boomed at the premium end but budget sets underperformed
- b. Both high-end and value-priced sets sold strongly at the same time
- c. Revenue rose but profits fell sharply due to raw material costs

2. The EU e-commerce sector has taken a hit recently. Since July 1, the EU introduced a €3 customs duty (import tax) on parcels under €150. What happened to Chinese imports as a result?

- a. They fell by around 10% to 15%
- b. They rose slightly as sellers rushed to beat further restrictions
- c. They plunged by 30% to 40%

3. Hyundai has grown faster than any other automaker in the US market recently, and it is doubling down on that momentum. The South Korean carmaker just ramped up a new facility in Georgia — but how much did it invest to build it?

- a. Around \$3.2 billion, funded partly by US federal grants
- b. Around \$7.6 billion, making it one of the largest foreign auto investments in US history
- c. Around \$12 billion, split equally with a domestic US manufacturing partner

4. Dollar Tree has reported a strange new problem affecting its party supplies aisle. Which gas, essential for floating balloons, is becoming scarcer and pricier due to conflict in the Middle East?

- a. Hydrogen, because it doubles as a fuel and is being diverted to energy markets
- b. Helium, because major supply infrastructure has been disrupted by the Iran war
- c. Nitrogen, because it is now classified as a dual-use military material

Economics

5. The PCE index (Personal Consumption Expenditure — the Federal Reserve's preferred measure of inflation, meaning rising prices across the economy) held steady in July. What was keeping it elevated?

- a. A surge in housing rents pushing up the shelter component
- b. High energy costs feeding through to the broader price level
- c. Strong wage growth pushing up service sector prices

6. President Trump recently announced plans to lift tariffs (import taxes) on ground beef to help lower food prices for consumers. Which group came out strongly against the move?

- a. Fast food chains worried about being undercut by cheaper imported beef
- b. US cattle ranchers and Republican lawmakers who back domestic producers
- c. Environmental groups concerned about increased Brazilian deforestation

7. South Korea's two biggest shipbuilders, HD Hyundai and Hanwha Ocean, are racing to break into a new market. Which sector are they targeting in the US, where domestic capacity has been struggling?

- a. Commercial cargo shipping, where aging US port infrastructure needs modernising
- b. Offshore wind vessel construction, driven by Biden-era green energy contracts
- c. Naval shipbuilding, where Hanwha has gained an early lead by acquiring a Philadelphia shipyard

8. A recent analysis looked at pay gaps between chief executives and workers at the 100 largest, lowest-paying US corporations. How many times more than the average worker did the average CEO earn?

- a. Around 85 times more
- b. Around 250 times more
- c. Around 614 times more

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium — the metal at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and the modern energy transition?

- a. Chile
- b. Australia
- c. China

10. Which 18th-century economist wrote the phrase 'It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest'?

- a. David Ricardo
- b. Adam Smith
- c. Thomas Malthus

Business

1. Lego just posted record first-half revenue — impressive for a toy company in a cost-conscious world. What made the result especially unusual?

b. Both premium and budget product lines sold strongly at the same time. That defies the usual pattern where consumers trade down in tough times, boosting cheap goods but hurting luxury ones — or vice versa. It suggests Lego has built unusually broad appeal, spanning gift-buyers splashing out on large sets and parents looking for affordable options alike.

2. The EU e-commerce sector has taken a hit recently. Since July 1, the EU introduced a €3 customs duty (import tax) on parcels under €150. What happened to Chinese imports as a result?

c. Chinese imports into the EU fell by 30% to 40% after the new duty kicked in. The €3 charge sounds small, but on low-value parcels from platforms like Shein and Temu it can represent a significant share of the item's price. The old rule — parcels under €150 entered duty-free — had made ultra-cheap Chinese e-commerce a massive business in Europe.

3. Hyundai has grown faster than any other automaker in the US market recently, and it is doubling down on that momentum. The South Korean carmaker just ramped up a new facility in Georgia — but how much did it invest to build it?

b. Hyundai's new Georgia plant cost \$7.6 billion, a huge bet on the US market. It is one of the largest single manufacturing investments by a foreign automaker on US soil. The timing is deliberate — with tariffs on imported vehicles rising, building cars in America shields Hyundai from the kind of cost hit that rivals importing from overseas now face.

4. Dollar Tree has reported a strange new problem affecting its party supplies aisle. Which gas, essential for floating balloons, is becoming scarcer and pricier due to conflict in the Middle East?

b. Helium — the gas that makes balloons float — is facing a supply squeeze linked to the Iran war, pushing up costs for retailers like Dollar Tree. Helium is not just for parties: it is critical for MRI machines, semiconductor manufacturing, and rocket propulsion. Unlike most gases it cannot be synthesised cheaply, so supply disruptions have wide knock-on effects.

Economics

5. The PCE index (Personal Consumption Expenditure — the Federal Reserve's preferred measure of inflation, meaning rising prices across the economy) held steady in July. What was keeping it elevated?

b. Elevated energy costs were the key factor keeping PCE inflation from falling further in July. The Fed watches PCE rather than the better-known CPI (Consumer Price Index) because it adjusts for how consumers actually change their spending when prices rise. Even with inflation cooling from its 2022 peak, energy prices have continued to complicate the Fed's path back to its 2% target.

6. President Trump recently announced plans to lift tariffs (import taxes) on ground beef to help lower food prices for consumers. Which group came out strongly against the move?

b. US cattle ranchers and some Republican lawmakers pushed back hard. Domestic beef producers rely on tariffs to stay price-competitive against cheaper imports, particularly from countries like Brazil and Australia. It is an unusual political moment — a Republican president drawing fire from his own party and traditional agricultural base by prioritising consumer prices over producer protection.

7. South Korea's two biggest shipbuilders, HD Hyundai and Hanwha Ocean, are racing to break into a new market. Which sector are they targeting in the US, where domestic capacity has been struggling?

c. Hanwha Ocean moved first by acquiring Philly Shipyard in Philadelphia, giving it a direct foothold in US naval contracting. HD Hyundai is pursuing its own entry. South Korea has dominated global commercial shipbuilding for decades — Korean yards produce ships faster and more cheaply than almost anyone. The US Navy, facing a backlog and capacity crunch, is an attractive new client.

8. A recent analysis looked at pay gaps between chief executives and workers at the 100 largest, lowest-paying US corporations. How many times more than the average worker did the average CEO earn?

c. The average CEO at these companies earned 614 times more than the average worker, according to the Institute for Policy Studies. CEO pay at these firms also rose 41.4% between 2019 and 2025. To put that in perspective: if a worker earns \$40,000 a year, a 614x multiple puts the CEO at around \$24.5 million. The ratio at typical large US companies is high — but this group represents the most extreme end.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium — the metal at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and the modern energy transition?

b. Australia is the world's largest lithium producer by volume, accounting for roughly half of global mine output. Chile holds the largest known reserves, concentrated in its famous Atacama salt flats. China, despite producing less raw lithium, dominates the processing and refining stage — giving it enormous leverage over the global battery supply chain even without topping the mining league table.

10. Which 18th-century economist wrote the phrase 'It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest'?

b. Adam Smith wrote those words in The Wealth of Nations, published in 1776 — the same year as American independence. The line captures his central insight: that self-interest, channelled through markets, can produce outcomes that benefit everyone without anyone planning it. Smith is often called the father of modern economics, and this passage remains one of the most quoted in the entire discipline.